

list the virtual hard disk files known to it. The list would usually be of the virtual hard disk files of the machines you've already created and might include the ones from those virtual machines which you removed from VirtualBox but didn't delete them altogether from the disk. This allows you to re-use the old operating systems you had removed from the list. If you're creating an entirely new virtual machine, select the "create new hard disk" option and click next. It will open a new window on top of the old one. We assume you're going to create a new hard disk.

- ▶ The new virtual hard disk creation wizard should be up now. What you'll see here might just astonish you. VirtualBox indeed supports a total of 4 different hard disk types.

The different virtual HDD formats supported by VirtualBox are:

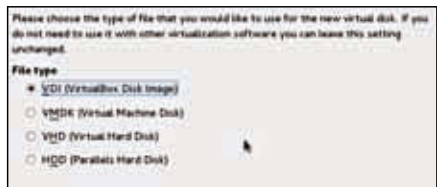


Figure 15: VirtualBox supports quite a list of file types for creating a new virtual hard disk

- ▶ **VDI (VirtualBox Disk Image):** This is the native file type used by VirtualBox for virtual machines and will give you the highest amount of flexibility and performance. Use this if you plan to use the hard disk or the virtual machine on VirtualBox and don't intend to give it to others.
- ▶ **VMDK (Virtual Machine Disk):** This file format is used by VMware Workstation and other VMware products. So, in case you're planning to use the virtual machine on a VMware product (such as VMware Workstation or VMware Player) later, this is your best bet!
- ▶ **VHD (Virtual Hard Disk):** This file format is used by Microsoft Virtual PC and Hyper-V virtualization system in Windows server. If you plan to use the machine on one of those, this is the one you want to use. In fact, Windows 7 supports booting from a VHD disk if you set the right parameters in the boot configuration database (you can modify it with `bcdedit.exe`). This might not work at all as the image you'd install later in VirtualBox would not be generalized. More instructions for the hardcore geeks and the brave at heart, the explorers at <http://technet.microsoft.com/en-us/edge/ff944958>.
- ▶ **HDD (Parallels Hard Disk):** This file format is used by the virtualization software called Parallels. This software is equally decent